SOCIAL FINANCE

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Multi Agency Information Sharing (MAIS) Standard Development Working Group

8th October 2025

PRIVATE AND CONFIDENTIAL

Agenda

14:30-14:40 (10m)	**1. Welcome** Andrew Newman, The ODI
14:40-14:45 (5m)	**2. Programme Recap** Andrew Newman, The ODI.
14:45-15:10 (25m)	**3. Refining our MAIS Conceptual model** Harry Angus, Social Finance.
15:10 -15:35 (25m)	**4. Information Governance** Howard Askew, The ODI.
15:35-15:50 (15m)	**5. Update on standards in development** Neil Majithia, The ODI
15:50 to 16:00 (10m)	**6. Next Steps** Andrew Newman, the ODI.

Things to be aware of

Conflicts of interest – Please inform the chair / secretariat if you think there is a risk.

Anti-competitive activities – Please inform the chair / secretariat if you think there is a risk of anti-competitive activity.

Intellectual Property - If you are concerned about the use of your contributions, please contact the secretariat.

Meeting Recording - We will record the meeting and using AI transcription tools.

Working together

1. Every voice matters
2. Please join in on the conversation, we don’t want this to be one way
3. If you’re happy to, keep your camera on
4. Please raise your hand if you want to come in, or drop your ideas in the chat
5. Respect the diverse viewpoints in the room, assume positive intent and remain open for different experiences
6. We will be using Miro to support our discussions today

Working together

Receive our regular newsletter

Sign up at:
- http://eepurl.com/jnmjYs

Website: https://socialcaredata.github.io/ (start here!)

GitHub: https://github.com/SocialCareData

We are using GitHub to work openly:

- Store our specifications
- Track feedback on specifications (Issues)
- Openly share project documentation
- Have Discussions to inform the development of standards

- In the future we will use GitHub to:
- Host and manage the development of any infrastructure or tools we need to develop
- Enable people to reuse our specifications and code

We will work to keep this simple and provide guidance when needed.

Today we will be using Miro

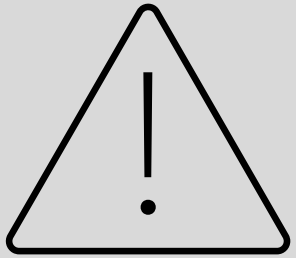
- **https://miro.com/app/board/uXjVJ9uERKU=/**
- **Password: 08102025**

Who's Here?

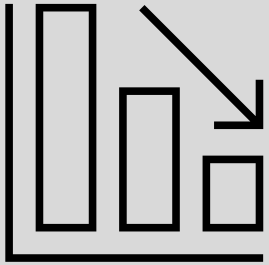
1. Have you attended a working group before?
2. What type of organisation are you from?
3. What is your role

Programme Recap

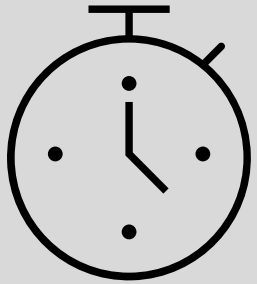
We're interested in using standards to drive four key benefits:



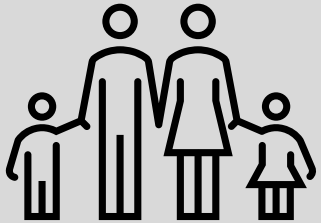
Improved data sharing to support frontline decision making



Better analysis to support strategic decision making

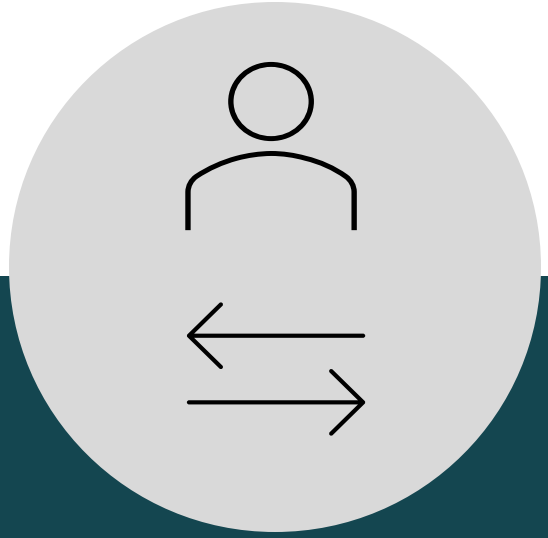


Access to productivity-enhancing tools for frontline staff



Enabling those using social care to see and contribute to their record

Our initial focus



MAIS

Standards to quickly discover who holds information about a person

Placements

Standard for describing placements

Piloting in the SW region

Our Standards for Multi-Agency Information Sharing (MAIS)

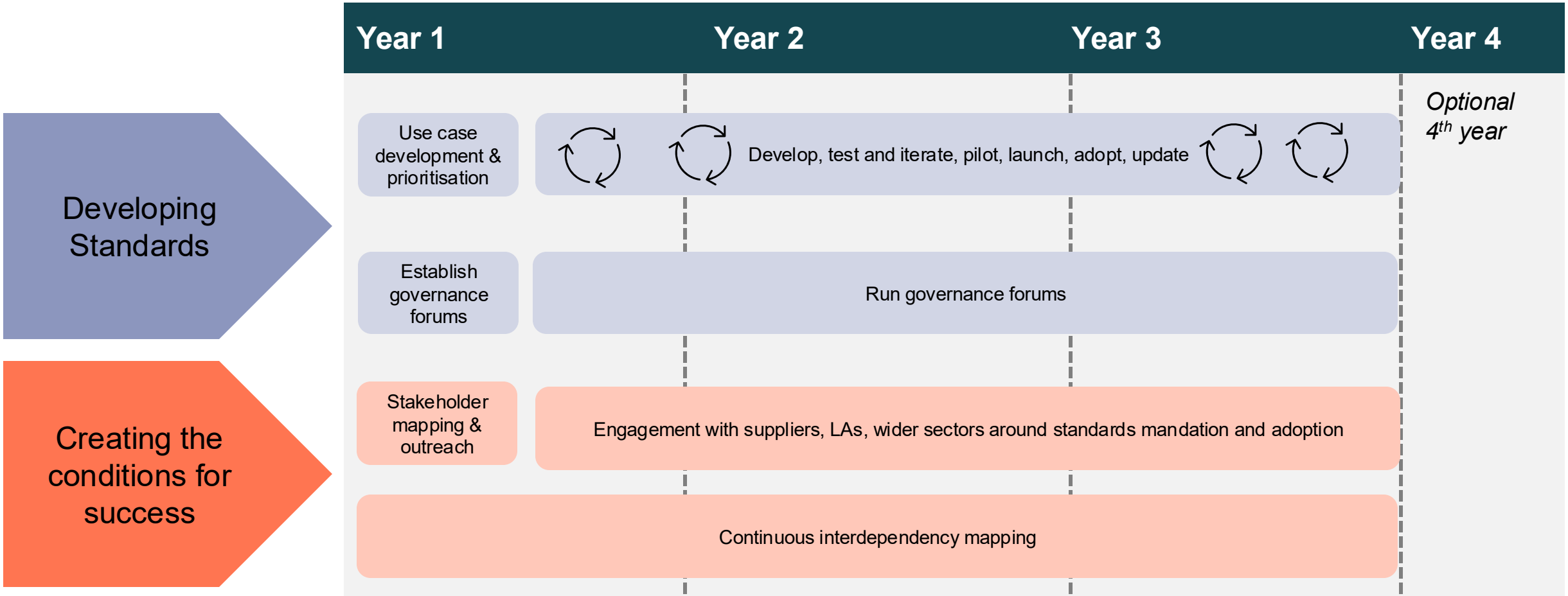
Person Standard:
Defining which fields should be standardised to enable identification of a person

Data Exchange Protocol:
To support movement of data between systems

Enablers:

- Controlled vocabs
- Info. governance
- Matching approach
- API catalogue

What might the next 3 years look like to help us solve the problems in the market using standards?



Refining our MAIS Conceptual model

Background

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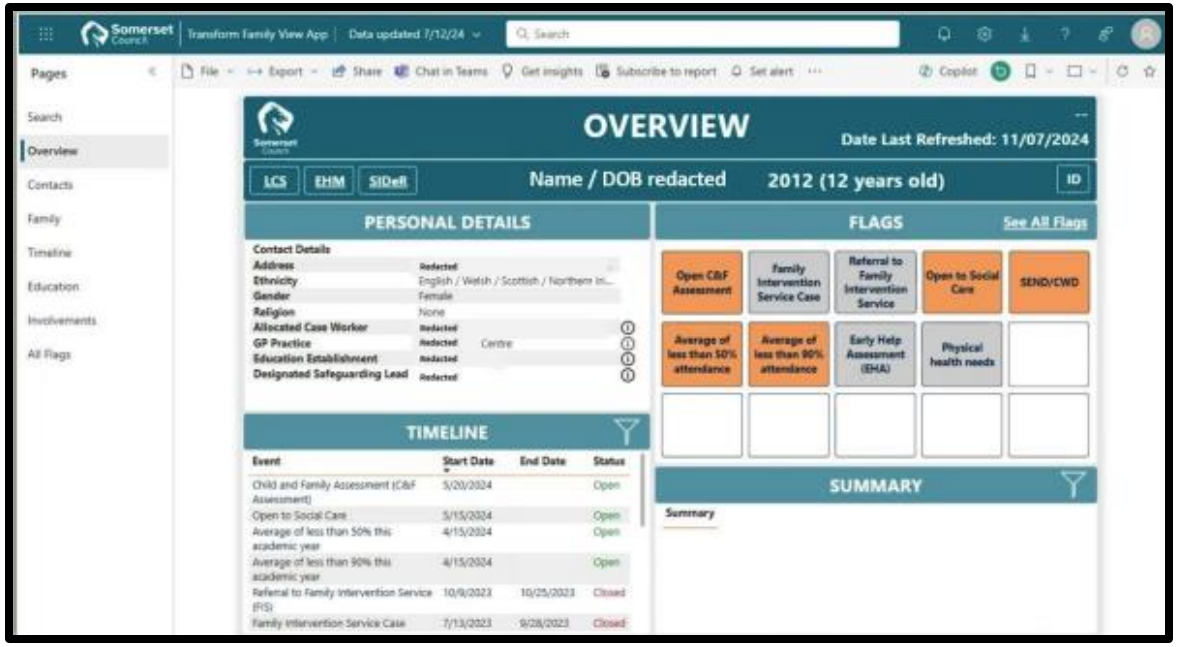
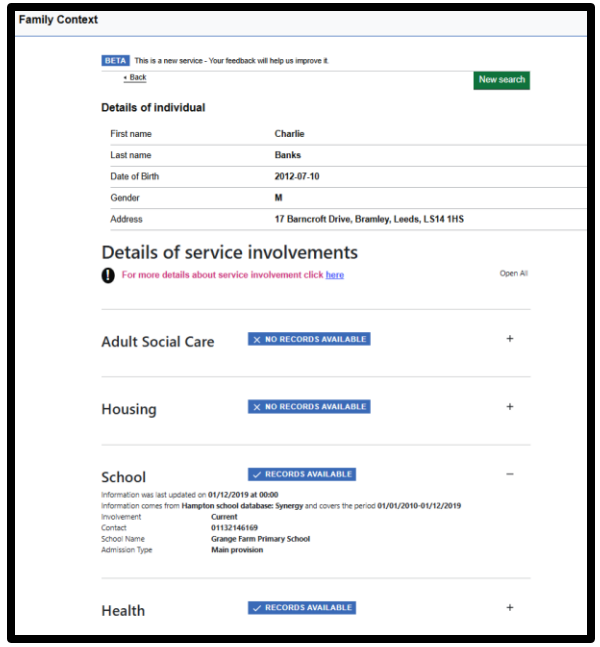
The problem we're trying to solve:

Agencies have poor oversight of **who** holds information about children and families and **what** information those agencies hold. This leads to increased risk that information gets missed, safeguarding decisions are made without considering the full picture and inefficiencies for staff having to 'ring around'.

How others have solved it:



Somerset's Transform data view – 'heavyweight'



Social Finance's Family Context – 'lightweight'

The problem: These don't scale easily

How solutions can work:

Two paradigms: Centralised vs. Decentralised models

Challenges of decentralised:

- Making the IG manageable
- Applying consistency to inconsistent systems
- Getting matching without SUI in inconsistent systems
- Adding enough partners for this to be valuable

Conceptual Model

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We know safeguarding professionals want a range of information from different systems across the safeguarding partnership.

As organisations and systems are dispersed, there are three challenges we need to overcome when thinking about describing elements:

1. We need to identify where information is held
2. We need to determine the conditions to permit a share
3. We need to define what sort of information will be shared

To do this we've designed a 'conceptual model' - we want you to break it!

Identifying where data is held and authority to share

Organisation
Who makes decisions r.e. sharing

E.g. Local authorities, Police Forces, Hospital Trusts

System
Where information is held

E.g. Case Management System or Records Management system

Sharing authority
Should information be shared

E.g. Signed information sharing agreement, authorised reason for request

Identifying what information should be shared

Involvements

States

Events

Three categories of ‘shareable’ information: Involvements, Events, Statuses

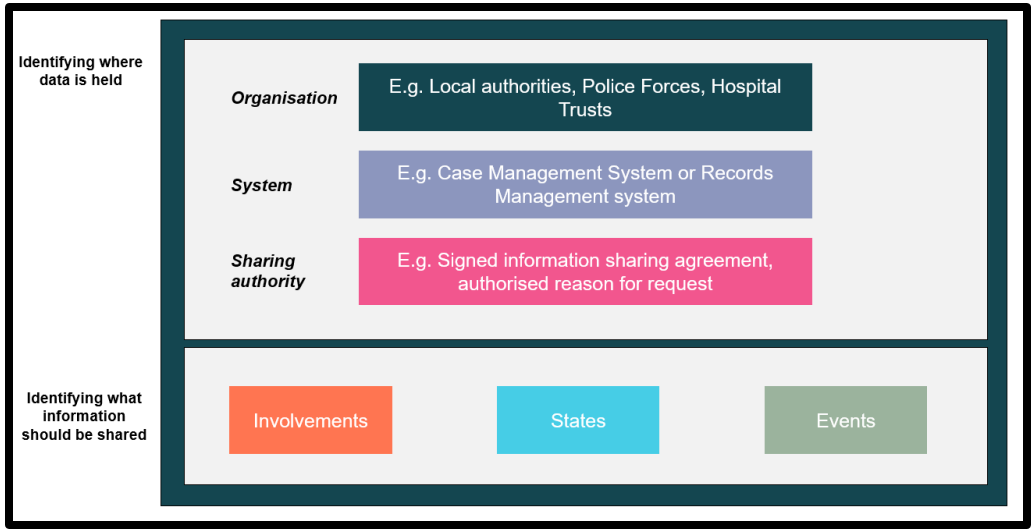
Involvement: *A sustained interaction between a service and an individual of interest to a safeguarding professional*
e.g. Start date, end date, status of involvement (e.g. open, referred awaiting assessment), name, role and contact details of relevant professional or team. ‘Failsafe’ generic numbers alongside.

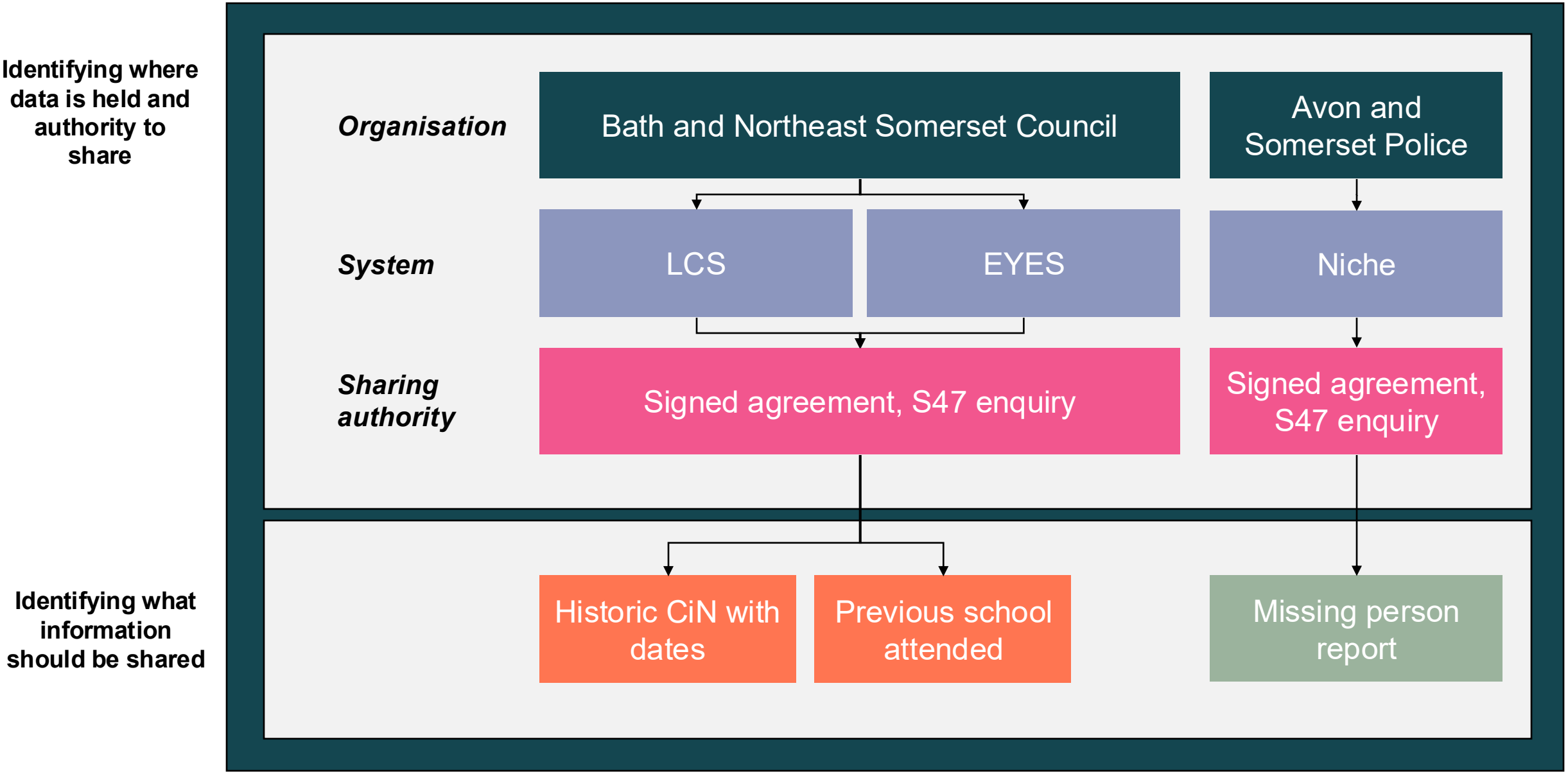
State: *A status of an individual that would be of interest to a safeguarding professional*
e.g. Family receiving housing support, Free school meals, persistent school absence

Events: *A specific incident that would be of interest to a safeguarding professional*
e.g. A+E attendance, missing person incident, DV incident, exclusions. Date of event

Worked example:

I'm a social worker in Bristol City Council. I make a S47 request to know more about Harry Angus. I get a return from Avon and Somerset Police, saying I went missing last week, and from Bath and Northeast Somerset Council, regarding a historic service involvement and previous school attendance.




Identifying where data is held and authority to share
Organisation
Bath and Northeast Somerset Council
Avon and Somerset Police
System
LCS
EYES
Niche
Sharing authority
Signed agreement, S47 enquiry
Signed agreement, S47 enquiry
Identifying what information should be shared
Historic CiN with dates
Previous school attended
Missing person report

Activity

Standards Working Group - 08/10/25 – Miro

Password: 08102025

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Information Governance

The Challenge:

To create a **distributed Single View capability nationwide**

without an unmanageable burden of manual approval,

we need to encode an information governance framework

that supports automated machine-to-machine data sharing.

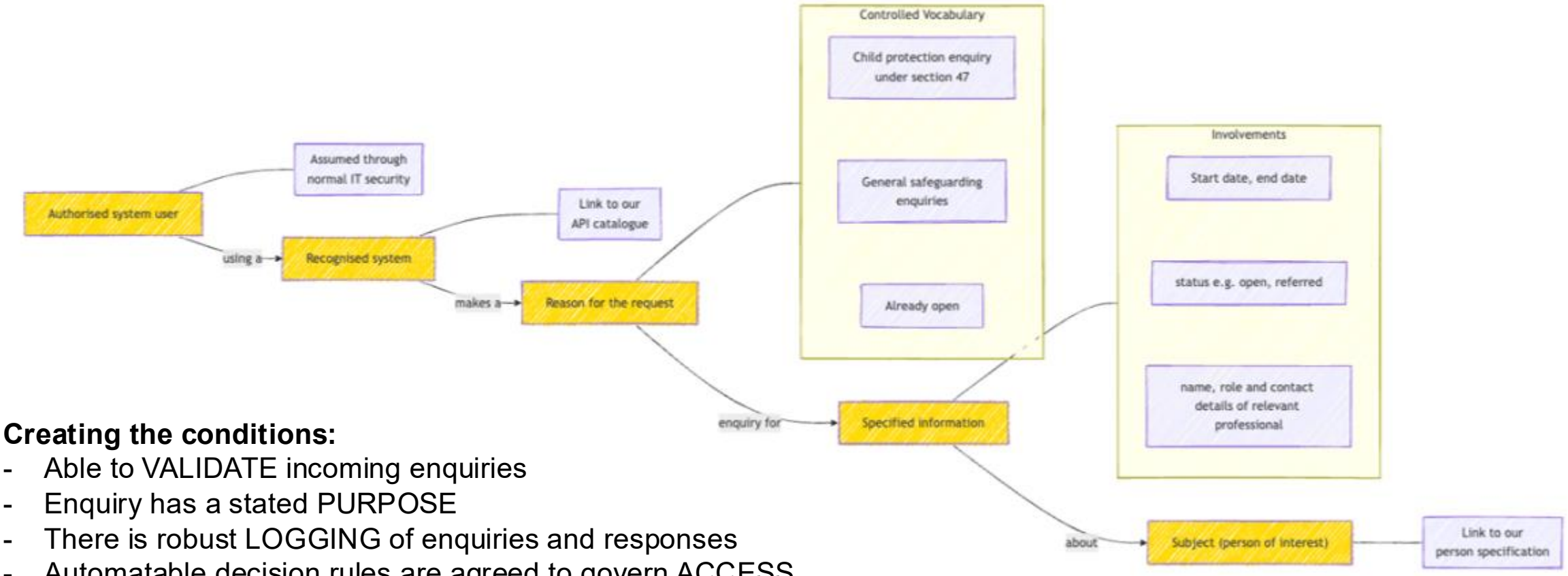
Today's Objectives:

Review the output from the IG deep dive.

Seek endorsement for that pattern for IG to take into testing

Discuss how the pattern can extend to other use cases

Information governance for automated data exchange



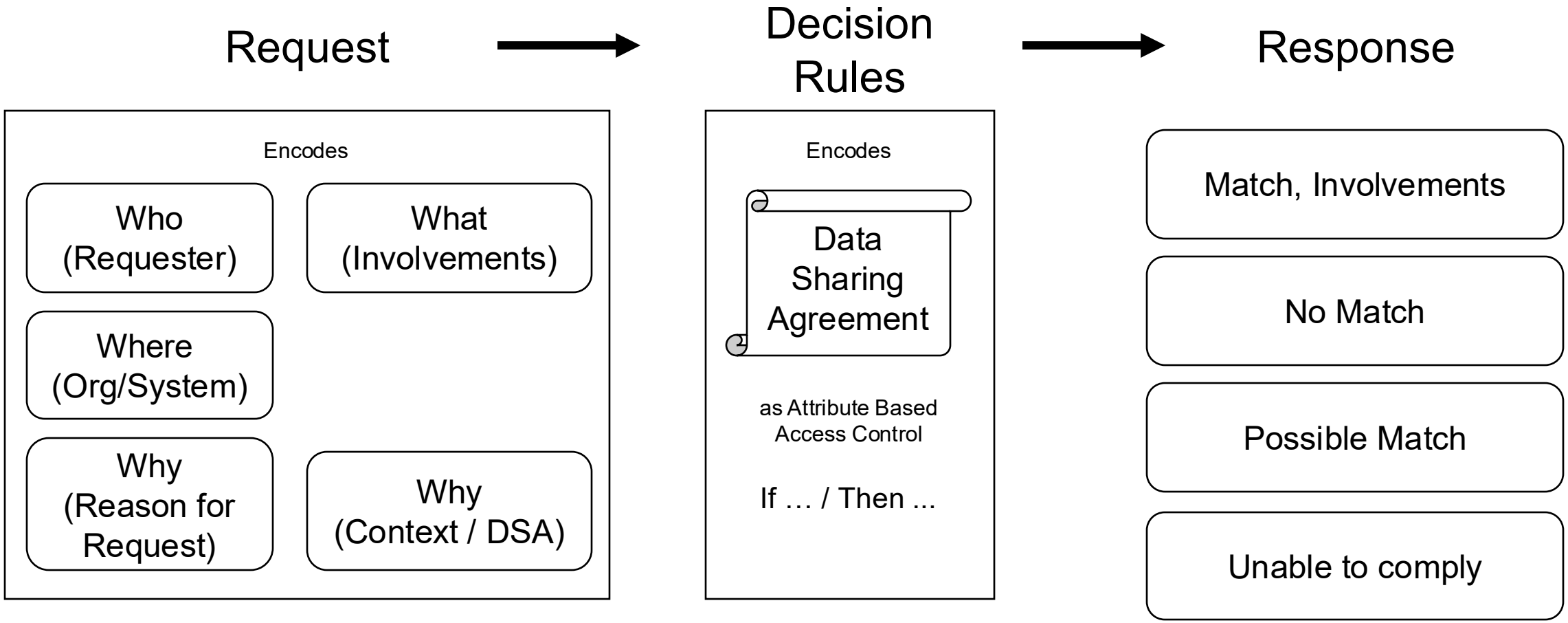
Creating the conditions:

- Able to VALIDATE incoming enquiries
- Enquiry has a stated PURPOSE
- There is robust LOGGING of enquiries and responses
- Automatable decision rules are agreed to govern ACCESS

Key Assumptions:

- IT systems are recognised, validated, secure
- Data matching is robust and comparable between systems

IG Requirements: What do we need to define or encode?



DISCUSSION: How to extend the pattern for other use cases?

Stay in this 'room' to discuss section 47 enquiries

Breakout 1:
General safeguarding enquiries (below S47 risk level)

Breakout 2:
Enquiries from other practitioners in the safeguarding system (eg: education safeguarding leads, hospital safeguarding teams, police safeguarding teams)

DISCUSSION: Does our IG pattern work for other use cases?

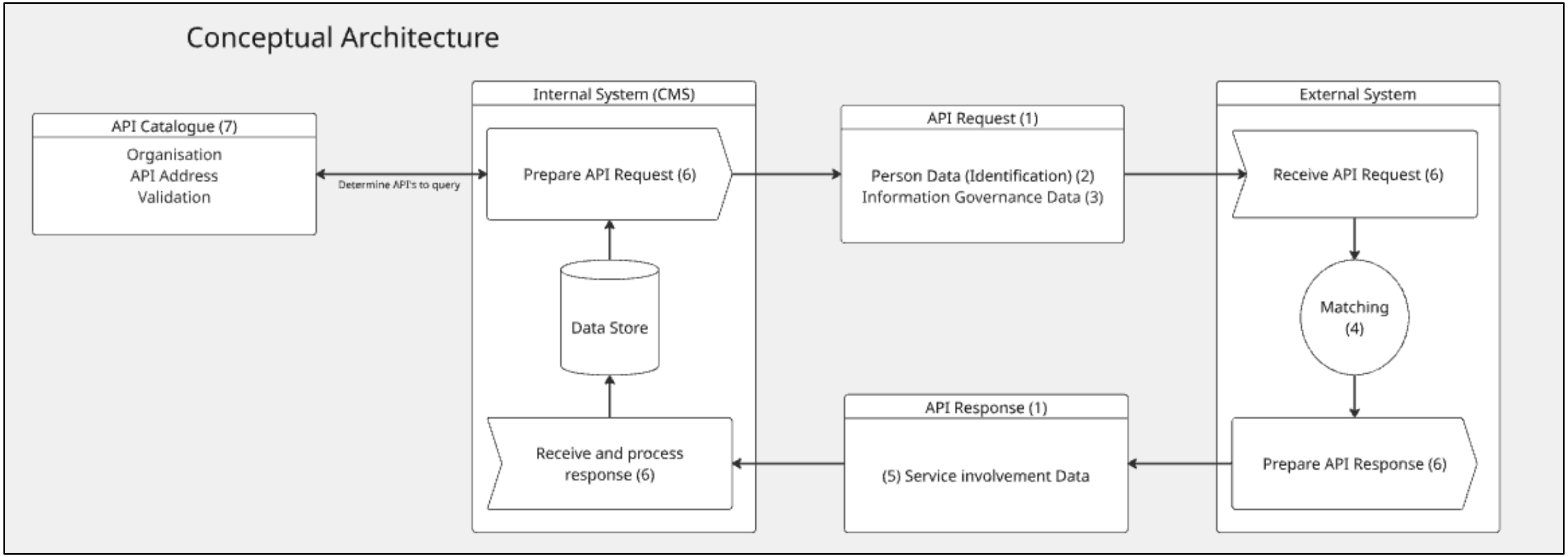
Feedback from group discussions

Next Steps:

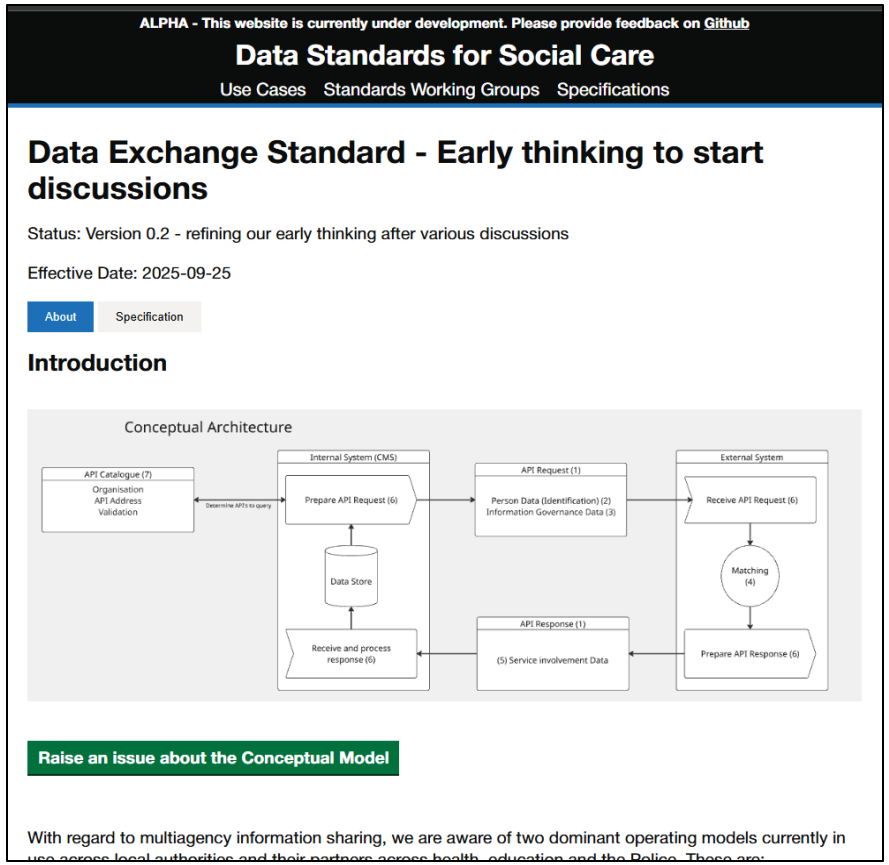
1. Draft a specification for decision rules which permit systems to share relevant data in specific conditions (attribute based access control)
2. Create draft vocabularies to standardise the reasons for a request and links to DSA
3. Propose a technical recommendation for implementing automated information governance

5. Update on standards in development

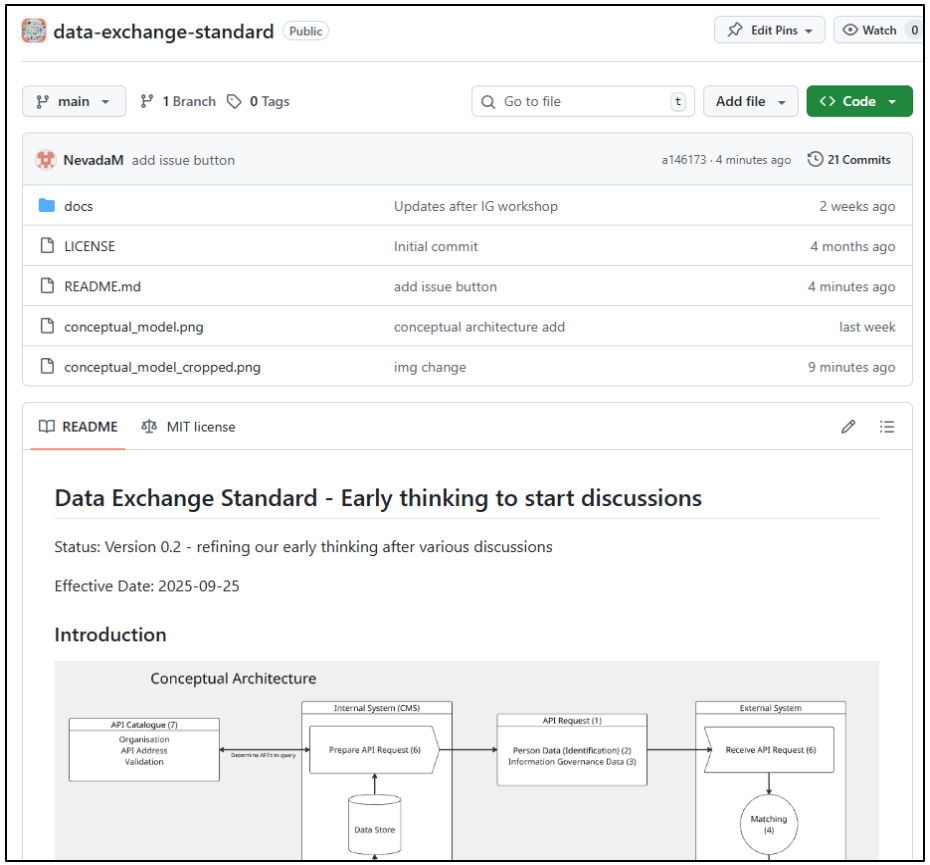
MAIS Conceptual Model: What we're working towards



MAIS Conceptual Model: More info and raise an issue



https://socialcaredata.github.io/spec/data-exchange/?tab=about



https://github.com/SocialCareData/data-exchange-standard

What standards do we need to get there?

Standard	Description	Location
Person Data (Identification)	A standard means to describe a person with the minimal amount of information required to identify them in the social care system	https://github.com/SocialCareData/person-standard
Data Exchange Protocol	A protocol for the exchange of requests for information and respective responses.	https://github.com/SocialCareData/data-exchange-standard
Matching Specification	The means by which a request for information about a person is matched to the person's record in a system (successfully or unsuccessfully)	
Information Governance	A workflow to ensure that requests and responses are conformant with information governance rules and regulations	https://github.com/SocialCareData/information-governance
Controlled Vocabularies	Established set of terms and codes to describe persons	https://github.com/SocialCareData/controlled-vocabularies
Catalogue of APIs	A register of agencies, with information about them and their API endpoints	https://github.com/SocialCareData/API-catalogue

Person Data (Identification)

Standard	Description	Location
Person Data (Identification)	A standard means to describe a person with the minimal amount of information required to identify them in the social care system	https://github.com/SocialCareData/person-standard

Person Data Standard (Identification)

Status

Version 0.2 - ready for testing

About | Specification

Describing a `Person`: Specification

Field name	FHIR alignment	PDS alignment	Cardinality	Data Type & Format	Description
`Identifier`	`Identifier`		1, Many (MUST)	Object	Unique identifiers (IDs) associated with the person.
↳ `Identifier Value`	`Identifier.value`	`UNIQUE_REFERENCE`	1 (MUST)	String(UTF-8)	A single unique identifier attached to the person (e.g., NHS number).
↳ `Identifier System`	`Identifier.system`		1 (MUST)	URI	System that the identifier adheres to (e.g., https://fhir.nhs.uk/Id/nhs-number).
`Name`	`Patient.name (HumanName)`	-	1 (MUST)	Object	Container for name parts.
↳ `Family Name`	`HumanName.family`	`FAMILY_NAME`	1, Many (MUST)	String(UTF-8)	Surname or family name.
↳ `Given Name(s)`	`HumanName.given`	`GIVEN_NAME`	1, Many (MUST)	String(UTF-8)	First and any middle names. If multiple, store as separate entries if possible.
↳ `Preferred Name(s)`	-	`OTHER_GIVEN_NAME`	0, Many (MAY)	String(UTF-8)	Any preferred names used by the person.
↳ `Use`	`HumanName.use`		0,1 (SHOULD)	Code:(usual, official, temp, nickname, anonymous, old, maiden)	How this name instance is used.
`Date of Birth`	`Patient.birthDate`	`DATE_OF_BIRTH`	1 (MUST)	Date (ISO8601: `YYYY-MM-DD`)	The person's date of birth.

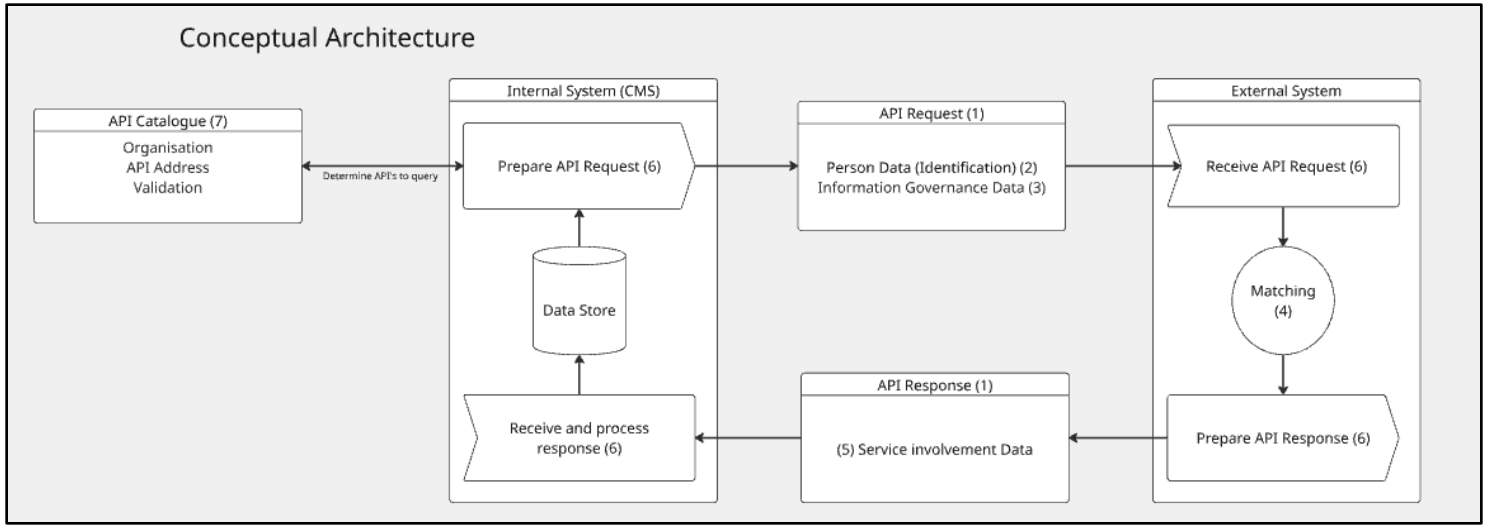
Open 22 Closed 17 Author Labels Projects

- Differing NHS numbers across devolved nations
  #51 · joe-massey opened 4 days ago
- Temporary NHS numbers as identifiers
  #50 · joe-massey opened 4 days ago
- Pre & post adoption records
  #49 · joe-massey opened 4 days ago
- NHS Number as identifier for unborn children
  #48 · joe-massey opened 4 days ago
- Unique Identifiers for Unaccompanied Asylum Seeking Children (UASC) Future issue
  Feature #47 · tomrintoul-SF opened last week
- Forename/Surname transliteration enhancement
  Task #46 · chrissweeneyhsc opened last week
- Legal Sex (vs Birth Sex) and Gender
  Feature #45 · chrissweeneyhsc opened last week
- Address types (aggregated issue) Future issue
  #43 · NevadaM opened last month
- [Content]: Identifier: NHS Number Future issue
  #42 · andjnewman opened on Sep 5
- [Content]: Should the person spec include a photo of the person enhancement Future issue
  Feature #41 · kyongCoram opened on Aug 14
- [Presentation]: Future proofing / backward compatability Future issue To discuss
  #37 · andjnewman opened on Jul 17
- Issue regarding People Spec Scope documentation To discuss

- Version 0.2 -- ready for testing
- Still answering issues and understanding where they fit in
  - Specifically, around edge-cases, like name transliteration
- Ensuring adherence to controlled vocabularies

Data Exchange Protocol

Standard	Description	Location
Data Exchange Protocol	A protocol for the exchange of requests for information and respective responses.	https://github.com/SocialCareData/data-exchange-standard



- Understanding the burden for suppliers
- Scoping where FHIR can be re-used
- Building out the decentralised approach

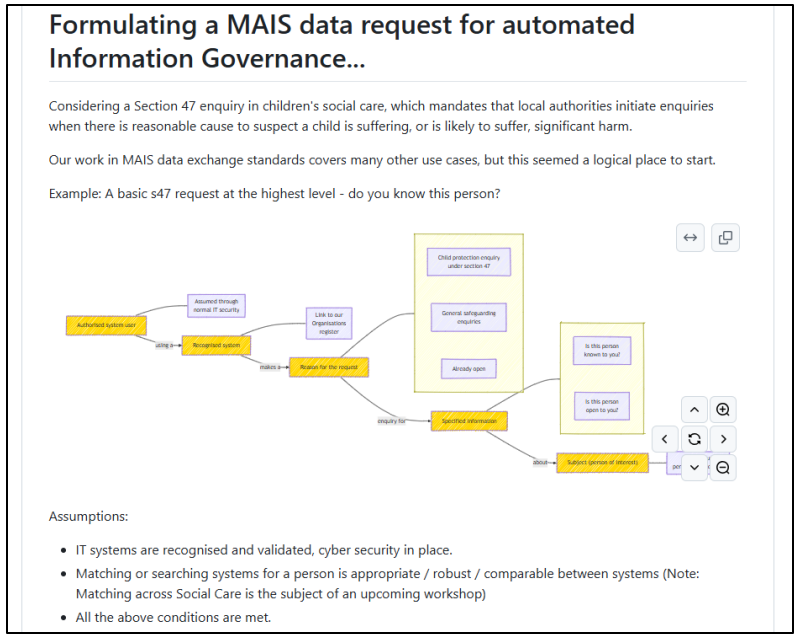
Matching Specification

Standard	Description	Location
Matching Specification	The means by which a request for information about a person is matched to the person's record in a system (successfully or unsuccessfully)	https://github.com/SocialCareData/data-exchange-standard

- Scoping...
- Provide your input!

Information Governance

Standard	Description	Location
Information Governance	A workflow to ensure that requests and responses are conformant with information governance rules and regulations	https://github.com/SocialCareData/information-governance



Formulating a MAIS data request for automated Information Governance...

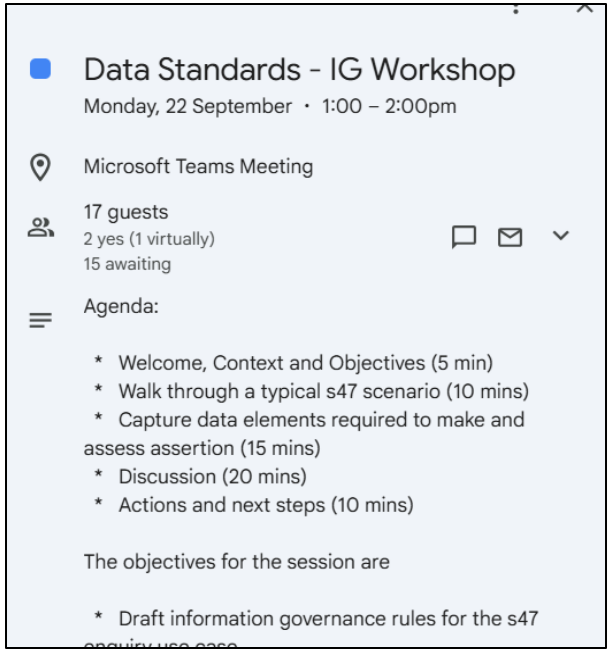
Considering a Section 47 enquiry in children's social care, which mandates that local authorities initiate enquiries when there is reasonable cause to suspect a child is suffering, or is likely to suffer, significant harm.

Our work in MAIS data exchange standards covers many other use cases, but this seemed a logical place to start.

Example: A basic s47 request at the highest level - do you know this person?

Assumptions:

- IT systems are recognised and validated, cyber security in place.
- Matching or searching systems for a person is appropriate / robust / comparable between systems (Note: Matching across Social Care is the subject of an upcoming workshop)
- All the above conditions are met.



Data Standards - IG Workshop

Monday, 22 September · 1:00 – 2:00pm

Microsoft Teams Meeting

17 guests
2 yes (1 virtually)
15 awaiting

Agenda:

* Welcome, Context and Objectives (5 min)
* Walk through a typical s47 scenario (10 mins)
* Capture data elements required to make and assess assertion (15 mins)
* Discussion (20 mins)
* Actions and next steps (10 mins)

The objectives for the session are

* Draft information governance rules for the s47 enquiry use case

- As presented earlier

Controlled Vocabularies

Standard	Description	Location
Controlled Vocabularies	Established set of terms and codes to describe persons	https://github.com/SocialCareData/controlled-vocabularies

Where do we need controlled vocabularies?

Person Spec

- Identifier.system.URI
  - A person can have more than one unique identifier. For example, they may be registered as case number 029834 in their local authority's social care management system, but they could also be referenced as patient number 2a309e in the same local authority's welfare provision database. To distinguish what system a described Identifier.value conforms to (in a machine-readable way), we require a value for Identifier.system, which conforms to the data type Identifier.system.URI.
  - This URI should be a namespace the identifier. While this is not strictly categorical data, and does not necessarily require a controlled vocabulary, we note that many identifier systems may not have associated namespace URIs.
  - We therefore propose defining (a sample) of our own, like FHIR does for a lot of identifier namespaces.
- Name.use.type
  - Similarly, a person can have more than one name on their record. The Name object, therefore, requires a Name.use data point, a categorical variable encoded by Name.use.type.
  - This is proposed to reuse FHIR's NameUse binding, where a name can be one of: {usual, official, temp, nickname, anonymous, old, maiden}.
  - We could expand on this terminology if necessary.
- Date-accuracy-indicator
  - Birth dates may be unknown, estimated, or accurate, across years, months, or days.
  - We therefore require a Birth Date Accuracy Indicator, which conforms to date-accuracy-indicator and is a triple of letters (eg. AEU for accurate year, estimated month, unknown day)
  - This is aligned with HL7 Australia's proposed addition to FHIR (link??), although with Y-M-D order as per ISO 8601
- Gender
  - Note discussion on this subject

- Scoping where controlled vocabularies are necessary
  - e.g. for Name.use.type
- Understanding how to present them in a machine-readable way

API Catalogue

Standard	Description	Location
Catalogue of APIs	A register of agencies, with information about them and their API endpoints	https://github.com/SocialCareData/API-catalogue

Defining a register of `Organisations`

The register/catalogue will have two kinds of data about each organisation. Firstly, it will contain publicly available summary information -- its name, identification, operational status, and more. Secondly, though, it will contain the technical (Point of Access (PoA)) information required for the organisation to be accessible via the data exchange mechanism we create. Both, listed below, are compared to the ODS Organisation Data model via the 'ODS alignment' column.

Summary Information

Note: FHIR has a resource to describe an Organisation that we align with in some areas -- with ODS also being built on FHIR, there is therefore clear alignment.

Field name	ODS alignment	Cardinality	Data Type & Format	Description & Reasoning
`organisationIdentifier`	-	1, Many (MUST)	**Object**	Unique identifiers (IDs) associated with the organisation. In ODS, this object is collapsed into the single `OrganisationCode`, inheriting from FHIR `Identifier.value`, because the Identifier System for all ODS data is the ODS Organisation Code namespace
↳ `Identifier Value`	`OrganisationCode`	1 (MUST)	String(UTF-8)	A single unique identifier attached to the organisation.
↳ `Identifier System`	-	1 (MUST)	URI	A link to the system that the identifier adheres to. Excluded by ODS as described above.
`organisationName`	`OrgName`	1 (MUST)	String(UTF-8)	Legal name of the organisation
`organisationType`	`OrgTypeID`	1 (SHOULD)	Code: {[WHAT	Type of the organisation e.g. Health, Justice, Education - not strictly necessary for the operation of data exchange but convenient in terms of data collection, stakeholder management and information governance.

ODS
Data Search And Export

- Building a v0.1 spec for what the catalogue will look like and what information will be inside
  - Using the NHS Organisation Data Service as a reference point: do you know anything about ODS?

Write issues for the next Working Group meeting!

SOCIAL FINANCE

coram better chances for children since 1739

open data institute

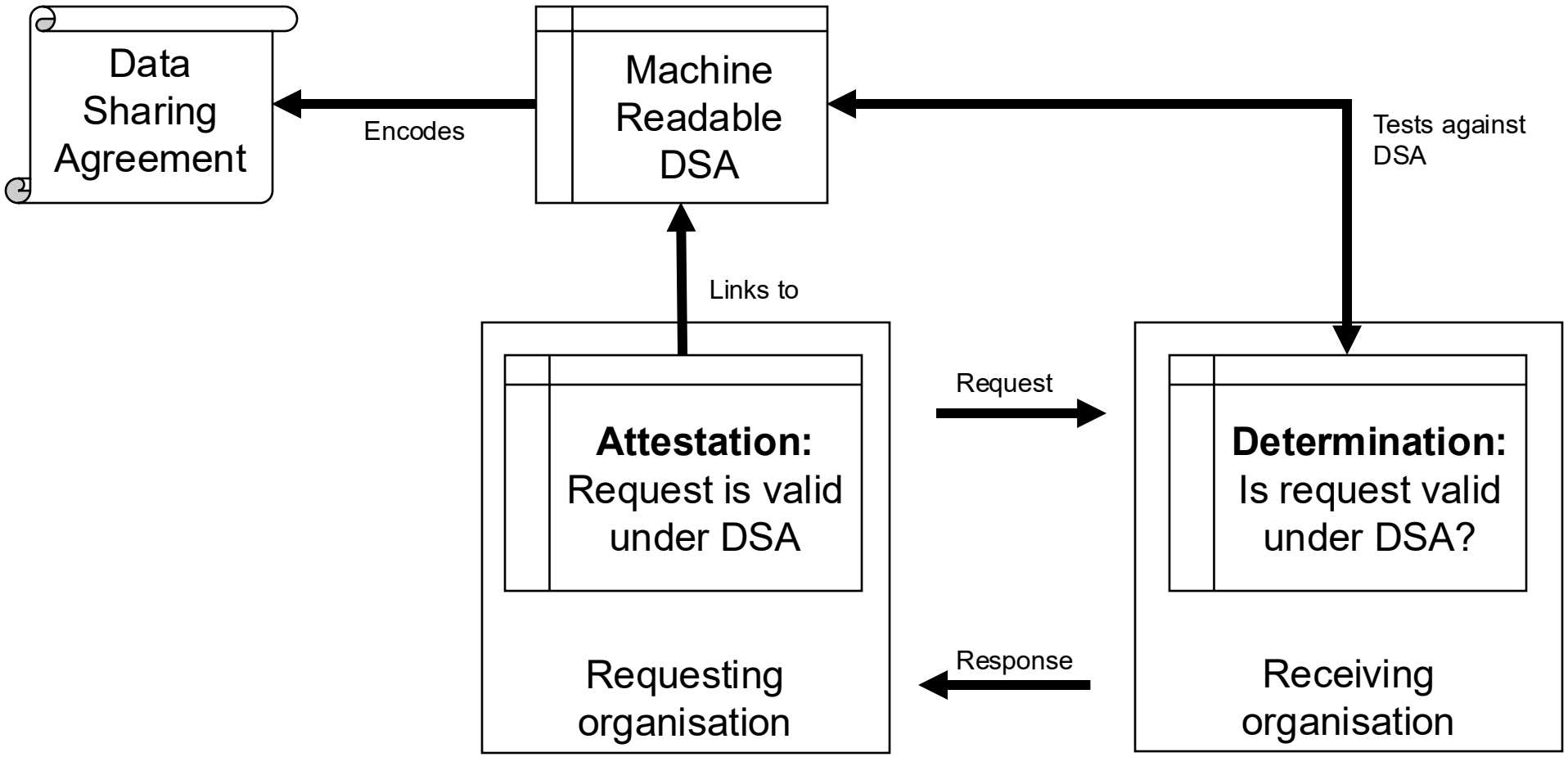
Thank you.

Contact:

MAIS:

Andrew.newman@theodi.org

IG requirement



IG requirement

1. Describe an existing policy (we will share X under circumstances Y, to be proven by Z)

2. Requestor > Describe a request for information and assert that it is valid under a specific agreement

3. Responder > Determine if a request is valid/not and communicate this

4. Log all this activity and describe what detail from what logs will be shared with whom, as a part of a policy

Removing the barriers to automating governance

Maintain a living DPIA

List triggers (e.g. s47 strategy meeting, missing episode)

Data minimization (Limit data requested per trigger)

Attribute-Based Access Control: decision = role + organisation + purpose code + risk context.

Time-boxed “break-glass” emergency access with elevated logging

Default deny unless conditions satisfied

Encode GDPR lawful basis for processing

Support redaction or suppression

Build in kill switches / circuit breakers and rollback plans

Logging who/what/when why/purpose code/basis recipient/decision

Removing the barriers to automating governance

- Audit dashboard
- Encode permitted purpose and reuse
- Agreed codes for partners, reasons and risk categories
- MAIS Metrics and KPIs
- Generalised DSA for ecosystem partners
- Transparency and privacy notifications (where safe)
- Auto-expire and deletion flags
- Directory of endpoints and duty contacts
- Message queueing and retries
- System monitoring and alerts